

About the Héritage Collection

The **Héritage Collection** contains approximately 37.5 million pages (over 1,000 archival collections) from c.1500 to 1985, digitized from Library and Archives Canada's microfilm holdings.

<https://www.crkn-rcdr.ca/en/our-crkn-members>

<https://www.canada.ca/en/library-archives.html>

An Essential Resource

- Unique archival records digitized from [Library and Archives Canada](#) holdings, with new material added regularly.
- Approximately 37.5 million pages of primary sources including government records, materials related to Indigenous history, genealogical resources, military records, and handwritten personal papers.
- Coverage from c. 1500 to 1985.
- Supports historians, researchers, students, and genealogists.

An essential resource

What you can find in the Héritage Collection

Genealogy Materials

Immigration records, church records, land records, family histories and papers, and voters' lists.

Indigenous Peoples

Extensive documents relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada.

Government Departments

Early records from Indian Affairs, Immigration, Health, Agriculture, Railways and Canals, Fisheries, and Natural Resources.

Military History

Materials covering the War of 1812, First World War, Second World War, and military administration in peacetime.

Prominent Canadians

Papers from prime ministers, governors general, premiers, cabinet ministers, explorers, scientists, writers, and artists.

How to Use Héritage

1. To get started, enter your search terms into the Héritage search box. The basic search helps guide you to collections that match your keywords. It searches descriptive information, microfilm reel numbers, metadata, and, where available, document text. To refine your query, use techniques from [Navigating the Collections](#), including exact phrases in quotes and operators like **?**, *****, **-**, and **|**. You

can also explore H ritage by subject matter by browsing the five thematic areas above (Genealogy Materials, Indigenous Peoples, Government Departments, Military History, and Prominent Canadians).

2. Next, choose the archival collection that best matches your research interest. Each individual collection page includes information about the collection as well as archival references. This information, drawn from Library and Archives Canada's [Collection Search catalogue](#), was generously shared to help ease of access.
3. When you find relevant records, download them with the **IMG**, **PAGE**, and **FULL** options (if available), and copy the persistent URL from the record.
4. For citations, please follow the [Citation Guide](#): cite Canadiana as the source and include the persistent URL. For publicly available works, please send a copy or link to CRKN.

FAQ

Is full-text search available now?

Due to its handwritten nature, most of the content in H ritage is not yet available for full-text search.

Will full-text search be available in the future?

Transcribing these records to produce searchable text will take time and resources and is part of our longer-term work on the [future of Canadiana](#). Future versions of H ritage will support full-text searching as records are transcribed.

What comes next for research support?

Over the coming years, additional research tools and infrastructure for enhanced metadata creation and linking will be developed by CRKN.